

NovaTech Solutions — Production Deployment Checklist v2.0

DevOps Team | Version 2.0 | Owner: Marcus Webb | Updated: March 2025

NOTE: This is the CURRENT deployment checklist (v2.0). The previous v1.x checklist is DEPRECATED. Do not use v1.x procedures for any production deployment after March 1, 2025.

Overview

This checklist must be completed for EVERY production deployment to the Atlas Platform or any NovaTech service. All steps are mandatory unless explicitly marked OPTIONAL. The deployer and a second engineer reviewer must both sign off before go-live.

[Figure 1: Deployment Pipeline Architecture — CI/CD flow from GitHub to Production. As shown in the diagram, all deployments flow through: GitHub PR Review > Automated CI Tests > Staging Deployment > Load Test > Security Scan > Production Deploy > Health Check. See the architecture.pptx for full system diagram.]

Pre-Deployment Requirements

#	Requirement	Responsible	Status Field
1	All automated tests passing in CI (GitHub Actions)	Engineer	☐ Done
2	Code review approved by 2+ engineers	Team Lead	☐ Done
3	Staging deployment validated (min 24h soak)	QA	☐ Done
4	Load test completed (simulate 3x expected traffic)	DevOps	☐ Done
5	Security scan (Snyk + SAST) — zero HIGH/CRITICAL findings	Security	☐ Done
6	Deployment approved in Jira release ticket	Team Lead	☐ Done
7	Rollback plan documented and tested	DevOps	☐ Done
8	Customer notification sent if user-facing change	Product/CSM	☐ Done / N/A

Table 1: Pre-deployment checklist

Deployment Execution Steps

Step	Action	Command / Tool	Notes
1	Notify #deployments Slack channel	Slack	Include service, version, ETA
2	Enable maintenance mode (if applicable)	kubectl apply -f maintenance.yaml	Skip for zero-downtime deploys
3	Deploy to production via CI pipeline	GitHub Actions: "Deploy to Prod"	Trigger only from main branch
4	Monitor deployment in ArgoCD	ArgoCD dashboard	Ensure all pods healthy
5	Run smoke tests	pytest tests/smoke/ --env prod	Must pass 100%
6	Check error rate in Datadog	Datadog dashboard	Error rate must be <0.1% after 10min
7	Check p99 latency	Datadog: Atlas API Latency	p99 must be <500ms

8	Disable maintenance mode	kubectrl delete -f maintenance.yaml	If enabled in Step 2
9	Update deployment log in Notion	Notion > DevOps > Deploy Log	Include version, deployer, time
10	Post deployment summary in #deployments		Status: SUCCESS or FAILED + next steps

Table 2: Deployment execution steps

DEPRECATED — Old Deployment Process (v1.x)

[OUTDATED — Do NOT use] The following was the old deployment process prior to March 2025. Included here for historical reference only. Old process used Ansible playbooks via SSH directly to production servers. This approach lacked audit logging, required manual rollback, and had no staging validation requirement. These procedures are deprecated and must NOT be followed.

Rollback Procedure

If deployment fails health checks (Step 6 or 7 above), initiate immediate rollback: (1) Trigger rollback in ArgoCD by selecting previous stable revision. (2) Notify #deployments with ROLLBACK INITIATED. (3) Confirm all services healthy within 10 minutes. (4) File incident report (INC-YYYY-XXXX) within 24 hours. (5) Post-mortem required for all production rollbacks.

Sign-Off Requirements

Role	Name	Signature	Date/Time
Deployer (Engineer)		_____	
Reviewer (Second Eng)		_____	
DevOps Lead (P0/P1 only)	Marcus Webb	_____	